

Career Site — Session Summary

Phase 1: Public Portfolio Site — Built & Deployed

March 20, 2026

What You Accomplished

In a single session, you went from zero coding experience to a live, professional portfolio website deployed on the internet. Every skill you used today transfers directly to every future project you build.

Built	A professional 6-section portfolio website from scratch
Learned	HTML — the structure of every webpage on the internet
Learned	CSS — styling, layout, and responsive mobile design
Learned	Git — saving and tracking code changes professionally
Learned	Terminal — the text-based tool every developer uses daily
Pushed	Code to GitHub — industry standard cloud code storage
Deployed	A live website to a real URL using Netlify
Redeployed	A live edit using the professional Git push workflow
Debugged	Real problems — token auth, quote marks, permissions

Your Live Site

Your portfolio is live and publicly accessible at:

`https://eleanore-colton.netlify.app`

This site is safe to share publicly. It presents you as a professional with a portfolio — not as someone actively job searching. The contact section has been updated to be neutral.

Your Technology Stack

Tool	Purpose	Where
Cursor	Code editor with AI assistance built in	<i>cursor.com</i>
HTML + CSS + JavaScript	The three foundational languages of the web	<i>Built in — no install needed</i>
Git	Tracks every change you make to your code	<i>Built into Cursor terminal</i>

GitHub	Cloud storage for your code — username: EleanoreColton	<i>github.com</i>
Netlify	Hosts your live website, auto-deploys from GitHub	<i>netlify.com</i>
Claude API	Will power AI features in Phase 2	<i>console.anthropic.com</i>

Your Project Structure

Your files are organized on your laptop at:

```
Documents/career-site/  
career-site/ ← your root project folder  
public/ ← your public portfolio page  
index.html ← the structure of your site  
style.css ← the styling of your site  
dashboard/ ← your private dashboard (Phase 2)  
.git/ ← Git's tracking history (don't touch)
```

Your Deploy Workflow — Use Every Time

Every time you make changes to your site, use these three terminal commands to save and redeploy. Netlify automatically updates your live site within 60 seconds of a push.

```
git add .
```

Stages all your changed files

```
git commit -m "describe your change"
```

Saves a snapshot with a note

```
git push
```

Sends it to GitHub — Netlify auto-deploys

Important: Always use straight quote marks in terminal commands. Mac autocorrect can change " to curly quotes which breaks the command.

Key Lessons From This Session

GitHub needs a Personal Access Token, not your password

When Git asks for a password, use a token from github.com/settings/tokens. Tokens start with `ghp_` and you can only see them once — save yours in your personal notes app.

Netlify needs GitHub repository permissions

If Netlify can't see your repos, go to github.com/apps/netlify and grant access. This is a one-time setup.

Ctrl+C cancels a stuck terminal command

If your terminal gets stuck waiting for input, press Ctrl+C to cancel and start fresh.

Quote marks matter in the terminal

Always type commit messages manually. Autocorrect changes straight quotes to curly quotes which breaks git commit commands.

Live Server requires the right file to be active

Click on index.html in the sidebar before clicking Go Live so it serves the right file.

What's Next — Phase 2

Phase 2 builds your private password-protected dashboard. This is where your career management tools live — only accessible to you.

- Password-protected dashboard page at /dashboard
 - Career command center — live overview of your search status
 - Credentials and continuing education tracker (your priority feature)
 - Claude API integration — the AI features that make this tool smart
 - Resume tailor — paste a job description, get a tailored resume
 - Outreach composer — AI-drafted messages for your contacts
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Your Learning Roadmap

Now — Phase 1 complete	HTML, CSS, Git, GitHub, Netlify deployment
Phase 2	JavaScript, password protection, Claude API integration
Phase 3	React — component-based apps like your colleagues build
Phase 4	Python — data, automation, AI tooling
Phase 5	Supabase — real database, cross-device sync
Phase 6	Mapbox / D3.js — maps and data visualization

Where to Save This Document

Save this PDF in your career-site project folder so it stays with your code:

```
Documents/career-site/session-notes/phase1-summary.pdf
```

You can also push it to GitHub so it's backed up in the cloud alongside your code. After saving it to that folder, run your three deploy commands in the terminal.
